

Use Case Manual

European Parking Card



A Use Case Manual is a description of a specific use case for the EU Digital Identity Wallet. It includes an introduction to the use case and the user journey, the state of play of the use case development, as well as references to the relevant technical specifications and infrastructures, legislation, and governance structures.

The Use Case Manual is designed for the Wallet implementers, Member States and other stakeholders interested in the development of the Wallet and its use cases.

The Use Case Manual is not intended to contain full detailed technical specifications for the use case. However, where such specifications are available, the Use Case Manual contains pointers to them.

Description

The European Parking Card for persons with disabilities (EPC) will promote the free movement for persons with disabilities and facilitate their short stays in Member States other than the one in which they reside. The EPC is issued as a proof of the right to use parking conditions and facilities, reserved for persons with disabilities. Each Member State defines its own application procedure and eligibility criteria.

The EPC is established by Directive (EU) 2024/2841 together with the European Disability Card (EDC) (see separate manual). The EPC will be mutually recognised in all Member States and will replace all existing parking cards at national, regional or local level issued in accordance with Recommendation 98/376/EC by **5 December 2029**. The issuance of the physical EPC displayed on the vehicle dashboard is mandatory. Member States have the option to complement it with a digital version. The Member States have the option to link a EPC to a specific licence plate number. The directive has EEA relevance. Its beneficiaries are the Union citizens and their family members. The complementary Directive (EU) 2024/2842 extends the provisions of Directive (EU) 2024/2841 and both cards to third-country nationals (non-EU citizens) legally residing in a Member State.

A digital EPC supports EU goals for inclusion and equality, freedom of movement, mobility, and digital public services. It naturally complements the **European Disability Card (EDC)** and can share much of the same infrastructure.

User Journey(s)

Scenario 1

1. User parks at parking spot marked for EPC holders.
2. A parking machine or mobile app requests EPC verification and, if required, parking fee payment.
3. User presents the EPC stored in their EUDI Wallet (via NFC or QR).
4. The machine or app verifies the EPC's validity.
5. If the parking space is not free of charge, the system may trigger online payment authorisation to settle the fee.
6. Parking session is recorded and authorised without the need for a human inspector.

Scenario 2

1. The vehicle approaches the entrance of an accessible parking area equipped with an automated gate and an automatic number-plate recognition camera.

- 2. A parking machine or the officer’s/inspector’s mobile app automatically requests verification of the European Parking Card (EPC).
- 3. The user presents the EPC stored in their EUDI Wallet (via NFC tap or QR code).
- 4. The machine or the officer/inspector verifies the EPC’s validity.
- 5. Once the EPC is confirmed, the camera records the vehicle’s licence plate and stores it in the registry as “authorised for disabled parking” for the duration of the session.
- 6. The gate opens and the driver parks in a designated accessible space. The system logs the entry time for potential fee calculation.
- 7. At any time, a parking officer can query the registry by scanning the plate to confirm that the vehicle is correctly entitled to occupy the space.
- 8. On exit, the gate re-scans the licence plate.
 - If parking is free for EPC holders, the gate opens automatically.
 - If a fee applies, the system prompts for payment and opens the gate once payment is confirmed.

Note: these scenarios are potential and might not reflect final implementation or requirements

Use case impact

The digital option addresses persistent issues: physical cards can be lost, stolen or forged; visual checks are slow and inconsistent; and cross-border interoperability is often poor.

Benefits

End-user/citizen value

- *Easy to store and present:*
The credential is stored in the user’s EUDI Wallet on their phone and is always available without the need to carry a physical card.
- *Cross-border recognition:*
The EPC supports harmonised verification across the EU, eliminating confusion or non-acceptance in other Member States.
- *Offline usability:*
The card can be shown and verified even in areas without internet connectivity, using QR or NFC.
- *Reduced risk of loss or damage:*
If the device is lost or replaced, the credential can be reissued without requiring a full application process.
- *Accessibility:*

The EUDI Wallet itself will be accessible in line with the requirements of Annex I of Directive 2019/882, thus benefiting the experience of cardholders.

Value for service providers

- *Fraud reduction:*
The digital card includes a verifiable signature, reducing misuse and false entitlement claims.
- *Efficient verification:*
Machines and apps can check validity instantly.
- *Standard format:*
A unified credential structure across all EU Member States improves operational clarity and integration with digital systems.

Economic value and potential market size

The **European Parking Card (EPC)** offers a significant opportunity to modernise mobility and parking services for persons with disabilities while supporting the EU’s wider digital identity goals.

Potential user base

- It is estimated that around **30 million EU residents** have a recognised disability status that, depending on national eligibility criteria, may entitle them to special conditions such as accessible parking, parking spaces reserved for persons with disabilities, free parking, etc. [Source](#)

Infrastructure scale

- According to the data collection of the European Parking Association Europe counts roughly **41 million regulated on- and off-street parking spaces**, with a much larger overall supply when unregulated spaces are included. [Source](#)
- More than **300 major municipal or private parking applications** operate across the EU, alongside **tens of thousands of smart parking meters and machines**, creating a large, ready-made verification network.

Economic impact

- Digital credentials reduce fraud and misuse of accessible parking, losses estimated in the tens of millions of euros annually in large cities alone, while lowering administrative costs for issuers.
- Automated verification and optional integration with **online payment authorisation** streamline parking transactions, cut enforcement costs, and free resources for municipalities and private operators.
- For citizens, a digital EPC removes paperwork and border-crossing barriers, ensuring that legitimate users can access accessible parking spaces when travelling, with or without internet connectivity.

Cross-border value

- Persons with disabilities frequently travel for work, tourism, or medical reasons. Seamless recognition of parking rights supports economic participation and complements the **European Disability Card**, sharing issuance infrastructure and verification methods.

By leveraging the EU Digital Identity Wallet, the EPC can therefore create a **pan-European market of millions of active users and thousands of relying parties**, municipalities, private parking operators,

transport hubs, and payment providers—delivering measurable efficiencies and improved mobility for people with disabilities while safeguarding scarce accessible-parking resources.

Issuers

Designated competent authorities and bodies (e.g., transport or social-affairs ministries) will be responsible for issuance of the EPC. Where a digital EPC is offered, the designated national authorities, already responsible for issuing the digital version of the EDC, can use the same secure infrastructure to issue the European Parking Card directly to the citizen’s EUDI Wallet. Therefore, since these authorities must issue EDC in any case, they can likewise issue EPC with minimal system updates.

Relying Parties

Municipal parking authorities and private parking operators are expected to be the main verifiers. Member States making use of the digital EPC must raise awareness so that machines, apps, and inspectors can all register and accept the credential.

Easy to store and present:

- Some Member States lack nationwide parking apps or smart meters, making machine-based verification harder.
- Smaller municipalities may rely on traditional inspectors, requiring phased deployment or hybrid solutions.

Synergies with other use cases

The EPC use case shares multiple technical, legal, and functional building blocks with other use cases particularly with ones in scope or social security. Those are:

- *European Disability Card*
- *European Health Insurance Card*
- *Online payment authorisation*

Use case implementation

Existing implementations

Directive (EU) 2024/2841 requires Member States to issue the physical EPC and enables, but does not require, a digital version of the card.

Legislation

The EPC is established by Directive (EU) 2024/2841 (same as for the European Disability Card), which is currently in force. More specifically, Directive (EU) 2024/2841 defines the physical EPC and allows (but does not require) a digital version. Member States shall adopt transposition laws by 5 June 2027 and will apply them as from 5 June 2028.

Current formats and upcoming formats for EPC:

- *National documents:*
Parking cards currently issued by Member States in accordance with Council Recommendation 98/376/EC. Member States are mandated by the Directive to replace these cards with the introduction of the European Parking Card by 5 December 2029 at the latest.
- *Physical EPC with digital features:*
Annex II to the Directive defines the format for the physical European Parking Card with a digital feature (QR code on the front side). Similar to the approach followed for the EU Digital COVID Certificates, this QR code when scanned would authenticate the document contents and check its validity. The QR code and, where appropriate, other digital features of the physical card are to be defined in a delegated act to be adopted by the Commission by 5 December 2025 (the adoption will be postponed till Q1 2026). The card is usually required to be displayed at the front of the vehicle in a way that is clearly visible for checking purposes.
- *Digital EPC - credential:*
The physical European Parking Card may be complemented by a digital version within a reasonable time after the Commission has laid down the technical specifications for it through implementing acts. There is no deadline for the adoption of these implementing acts. The specifications shall build on the experience on digitalisation of certificates and documents, such as the EU Digital COVID Certificate, and the empowering provision refers to enabling the use of the European Parking Card in “a digital identity wallet at Union level”.

Technical specifications, software libraries and infrastructure

The technical specifications for the EDC will be determined in an upcoming Implementing Act adopted further to Directive (EU) 2024/2841.

